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Courtesy X

Over 1,000 Gaza orphans graduated at Al Wafa Orphan Village in Khan Younis in a ceremony that echoed more with absence than applause.

Caps of Courage: 1,000 Gaza orphans graduate amid war

Gaza kids graduate without parents in a ceremony marked by grief and resilience

DUBAI
BY DEVADASAN K P
Chief Visual Editor

What is usually a day of pride and familial joy became a heart-rending testament to loss in Gaza, where over 1,000 orphans attended a graduation ceremony that echoed more with absence than applause.

Dressed in caps and gowns, each child clutched a photograph of their missing mother, father, or both as they ascended the stage at Al Wafa Orphan Village in Khan Younis — marking the centre's first graduating class since opening in January.

Instead of cheers, the air was thick with quiet sorrow and solemn silence. In footage shared by journalist Abdallah Al Attar, many young

Dressed in caps and gowns, each child clutched a photograph of their missing mother, father, or both as they ascended the stage at Al Wafa Orphan Village in Khan Younis — marking the centre's first graduating class since opening in January.



Watch: Gaza orphans tear up during graduation ceremony

graduates are seen wiping away tears in the absence of the people they longed for most.

Yet in that anguish lay a spark of resilience: this bittersweet milestone was also a symbol of perseverance, of a

future carried forward despite unimaginable tragedy.

Broader reality

Behind this moving ceremony lies a broader Gaza reality. Relief agencies warn of a staggering humanitarian collapse — over 62,000 Palestinians have perished since October 2023, including many children, while starvation and destruction ravage communities.

On the humanitarian front, the blockade continues to choke the enclave. Aid deliveries remain grossly insufficient, and civilian access to basic necessities is desperately limited.

Amid global tension, escalating violence, and fragile ceasefire talks, the graduation offers a fleeting yet powerful glimpse of hope — and the urgent need for peace. These children, having survived unspeakable loss, graduated not just into the world but as living testaments to human endurance.

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Dubai's co-living rental spaces get major upgrades

TENANTS MUST GET MINIMUM SPACE UNDER 'OCCUPATION DENSITY' RULE

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Residents in Dubai opting for co-living rental options find landlords are giving them more 'space'. Or at the very least, ensuring they are provided with the 'minimum space'.

Landlords offering co-living leases are now making it a point to give 5 square metres of space to each tenant. That's as per the Dubai Municipality requirements on co-living tenants' rights on 'occupancy density standards'.

"Additionally, approvals from Dubai Civil Defence and Dubai Municipality are necessary for any internal partitions or modifications (made by the landlord)," said Vishal Tinani, corporate lawyer and a specialist in regulatory affairs.

Dubai authorities have been stepping up their campaigns against illegal partitioning, whereby landlords squeeze in more co-sharing tenants into a room or apartment. In fact, landlords who break the rules are facing a 'zero tolerance' approach from the authorities.

Steady demand

According to property market sources, the market is seeing steady demand for co-living or co-sharing rental options — and those that are in full compliance with the rules. So far, there are no signs of any sudden increases in co-living rental areas any-

LANDLORDS MUST ...

- Specify the deposit amount in the co-sharing agreement.
- Issue receipts to acknowledge the deposit.
- Refund any remaining balance at the end of the tenancy, subject to lawful deductions for damages or unpaid utilities.

where in Dubai after the crack-down by the authorities.

The only visible difference is that 'new sublet listings dropped by 30 per cent—35 per cent', according to Rajneel Kumar, co-founder and Chief Operating Officer at the Rentify platform.

Instead, what the market is seeing is more exposure for licensed co-living options. Sure, they carry a higher rent than the off-market sub-leases, but that comes with the territory. Also, more landlords are adding co-leased options in areas like Business Bay, Dubai Marina, the Downtown, JLT and Al Barsha.

On co-living rentals, landlords typically ask for Dh1,000 to Dh2,000 as security deposits from the tenants, compared to Dh5,000 to Dh7,000 for a full one-bedroom unit, says Tinani.

"All additional occupants residing for one month or longer must be registered in the Dubai Land Department system using the Dubai REST app," added Tinani.



SPORT

Salah makes history with third PFA player of the year award

Egyptian also won award in 2018 and 2022 | P13

From Paris to Barcelona, residents fight overtourism

European cities reel from surging numbers

PARIS

When Olivier Baroin moved into an apartment in Montmartre about 15 years ago, it felt like he was living in a village in the heart of Paris. Not anymore.

Stores for residents are disappearing, along with the friendly atmosphere, he says. In their place are hordes of people taking selfies, shops selling tourist trinkets, and cafés whose seating spills into the narrow, cobbled streets as overtourism takes its toll. Baroin has had enough. He has now put his apartment up for sale.

From Venice to Barcelona to Athens, European cities are struggling to absorb surging numbers of tourists. Residents in Montmartre, one of Paris' most popular



tourist neighbourhoods, are now pushing back, staging protests with banners.

In Barcelona, thousands have taken to the streets this year, some wielding water pistols, demanding limits on cruise ships and short-term tourist rentals. Venice now charges an entry fee for day-trippers and caps visitor numbers. And in Athens, authorities are imposing a daily limit on visitors to the Acropolis, to protect the ancient monument from record-breaking tourist crowds.

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